Brightline Studio Team Handbook

Welcome to Brightline Studio, a small remote design and development studio. This handbook explains how we work, how time off works and what equipment you get. Our working hours are flexible, but everyone is online for core hours from 10 am to 2 pm in their own time zone. We use Slack for quick questions and Notion for anything that needs to last. Projects run in two-week cycles. Each cycle starts with a planning call on Monday and ends with a short demo on Friday, where everyone shows what they shipped. Write updates in the project channel instead of private messages, so the whole team can follow along. New team members get a buddy for their first month, who answers questions and reviews their first pull requests.

Time off

Every full-time team member gets 25 paid vacation days per year, plus public holidays in their country. Vacation days reset on January 1, and you can carry over up to 5 unused days into the next year. Sick leave is separate and unlimited, but tell your lead before 10 am if you are unwell. Book vacations of more than 3 days at least two weeks ahead in the time-off calendar. Parental leave is 16 weeks fully paid for every parent, and it can be split into two blocks within the first year. If you need time off for an emergency, tell your lead as soon as you can and sort out the calendar later. Unused sick leave does not carry over and is not paid out.

Equipment and home office

New team members get a one-time equipment budget of 1,500 US dollars for a laptop, monitor and chair. After that, each person gets 300 US dollars per year for home office upgrades. Keep the receipts and submit them in the expenses form within 30 days. The laptop belongs to the studio and is returned if you leave. The studio also pays for a co-working space up to 150 US dollars per month if you prefer not to work from home. Internet costs are covered up to 50 US dollars per month. Software licenses are bought by the studio, so never pay for tools with your own card.

Reviews and growth

Performance reviews happen twice a year, in June and December. Each person also gets a learning budget of 600 US dollars per year for courses, books and conferences. Ask your lead to approve a course before you buy it. Promotions are discussed in the December review. Every quarter you can spend one full day on a side project or learning, called a growth day. Share what you learned in the next Friday demo. If you want to move to a new role inside the studio, talk to your lead first, then post in the careers channel.